PHASE-1

THE HIDDEN PHOTOGRAPH

Storyline

Twenty years ago, a brilliant student and amateur cryptographer named Arjun Varma disappeared without a trace from the college campus.

No one knew what happened to him.

The only thing he left behind was a photograph recovered from an old, damaged computer belonging to him.

The photograph looks completely ordinary.

There is no name.

No date.

No visible message.

But investigators noticed something strange about the file.

Before disappearing, Arjun had written one line in his notebook:

"What you see is only the surface. The truth is buried deeper, and even then it rests on a base of eight times eight."

In the margin beside it was a small sketch: a ring hung ten feet above the ground, with a net beneath it.

"Begin under the open sky, where the ball must pass through the ring."